



Investment Strategy Challenge 2026

Each team that participated in the Investment Strategy Challenge is required to present an innovative investment strategy based on the following rules:

- **Background:** One of our clients is eager to explore investment opportunities across a diverse range of asset classes. As part of Natixis Global Markets, your team will be responsible for developing a customized product proposal that includes structured products tailored to align with the client's specific investment objectives and risk tolerance. The proposed investment format will consist of either structured notes or over-the-counter (OTC) products.
- **Format:** The proposal should be in the form of PowerPoint slides (in PDF format), with a maximum of 10 slides in total, excluding agenda, executive summary and appendix pages. Additional data set and calculations can also be submitted in Excel format.
- **Submission Deadline:** 11 October 2026, 23:59 deadline
- **Proposal Content:** You may include following content in the PowerPoint: assumptions, rationale, product design and payoffs, back-testing results under different scenarios, risks, etc.
- **Target Client:** The proposed strategy must be tailored to ***one of the three clients mentioned below***. The proposal should identify and align with the client's risk appetite and investment objectives.
- **Investment Horizon:** Students should select their investment horizon based on the type of client they are working with, with a maximum duration of 30 years. The trade date or issue date is assumed to be September 17, 2026.
- **Underlying Asset(s):** The proposal must clearly specify the underlying assets. The product can consist of either single or multiple underlying assets and can be cross-asset.

The list of eligible asset classes is as below:

- Equities, FX & Rates, Government and Credit Bonds, Commodities, and Digital Assets.
- Limitations:
 - Equities: Penny stocks with a market capitalization of < USD 250M are prohibited
 - Exchange-traded Products: Daily trading volume should be more than USD 5M over the previous half year. There is no limitation on daily trading volume on OTC products
 - Regions: All countries except OFAC Sanctioned Countries
 - All assets should be searchable on Bloomberg



Funding Grid as below¹:

	EUR	USD	JPY	AUD	CHF	NOK
1Y	3.13%	4.78%	1.70%	5.15%	0.27%	4.80%
2Y	3.52%	5.30%	2.12%	5.46%	0.69%	5.02%
3Y	3.69%	5.52%	2.40%	5.62%	0.89%	5.19%
5Y	3.89%	5.69%	2.82%	5.83%	1.09%	5.21%
7Y	3.95%	5.75%	3.23%	5.98%	1.08%	5.14%
10Y	4.06%	5.82%	3.52%	6.16%	1.10%	5.10%
20Y	4.24%	6.04%	4.21%	6.38%	1.03%	4.77%

The top proposals will be selected for a final round of presentations, where the competitors will have the opportunity to pitch their ideas to a panel of industry experts.

Scenario 1:

Purple Magic Capital is a sophisticated hedge fund based in Korea, with an AUM of USD 10Bn. The fund specializes in macro-driven strategies and event-driven opportunities, with a strong preference for customized and exotic structured products that capitalize on market dislocations and regulatory shifts.

The fund manager has recently closed its partnership with one of the asset managers due to a loss of USD 30M. He is now seeking to redeploy KRW 135Bn in innovative structured products that can capture emerging macro catalysts and event-driven opportunities in the current market environment, and he has now invited your team to submit a proposal.

Scenario 2:

NKE Private Wealth is a prestigious single-family office catering to the Chak family, a third-generation business dynasty with businesses spanning technology infrastructure, renewable energy plants, and real estate projects across Japan and Greater China. The family patriarch, having recently completed the succession of operational responsibilities to the next generation, is now focusing on strategic asset allocation and legacy planning in such a volatile market backdrop.

With a combined family net worth exceeding USD 2Bn, the family seeks to deploy USD 100Mn that reflects their dual objectives: capital appreciation to support future generations and meaningful exposure to sectors driving the digital transformation in Asia. The family has a particular interest in opportunities that bridge traditional Asian markets with emerging technologies, given their operational expertise in these domains.

¹ For any funding currency that is not included in the provided table, you may consider using a derivative to swap the cash flow. Additionally, if the tenor you are looking for is not available, please use linear interpolation to estimate the funding for your convenience.



Your mandate is to collaborate with NKE's investment committee to design an innovative structured product that captures the family's vision while managing downside risks appropriate for generational wealth preservation.

Scenario 3:

Nordvik Energy Services ASA is a mid-sized Norwegian oilfield services and marine logistics company headquartered in Stavanger, Norway. Founded in 1987, the firm is a trusted partner for North Sea operators, providing drilling support, subsea maintenance and cargo logistics services across Norwegian and UK Continental Shelf. With a record-breaking revenue growth of 13.5% YoY and operations spanning Norway, the United Kingdom, and Latin America, Nordvik has built its franchise on operational reliability and long-standing client relationships with major North Sea producers.

With ongoing oil price tension from the Iran War, Nordvik's newly appointed CFO is tasked with allocating NOK 950Mn to redesign the company's treasury and risk management strategy. Most of its revenues is denominated in USD, while its operating expenses and financing costs are predominantly denominated in NOK. Your team will be working closely with Nordvik's treasury team to design a comprehensive risk management and investment strategy that stabilizes the company's earnings, protects its balance sheet, and positions it for sustainable growth.